

STRATEGIC RESEARCH · DE BEERS GROUP · 2025

A Diamond is Forever

The life of a slogan, 1947–2025

On the evolution of the natural diamond's founding narrative and on the terms of its renewal.

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ABOUT THIS RESEARCH

This research was conducted in 2025 for De Beers Group as the strategic foundation of *A Diamond is Forever* (hereafter ADIF), the platform dedicated to the cultural, emotional and symbolic power of natural diamonds. It follows the trajectory of a single sentence written in Philadelphia in 1947 and re-traces the cultural work that sentence accomplished over seven decades. It then examines the conditions under which the line must now operate, from a market divided by laboratory-grown stones to a generation that no longer receives the engagement ring as a given, across three territories whose relationship to the diamond has little in common, and derives from this reading a strategic response built on storytelling understood as cultural transmission.

The brand identity developed alongside this work, its manifesto and tone of voice as well as its visual system, has been deliberately left out of the present document. What remains is the analysis and the strategy.

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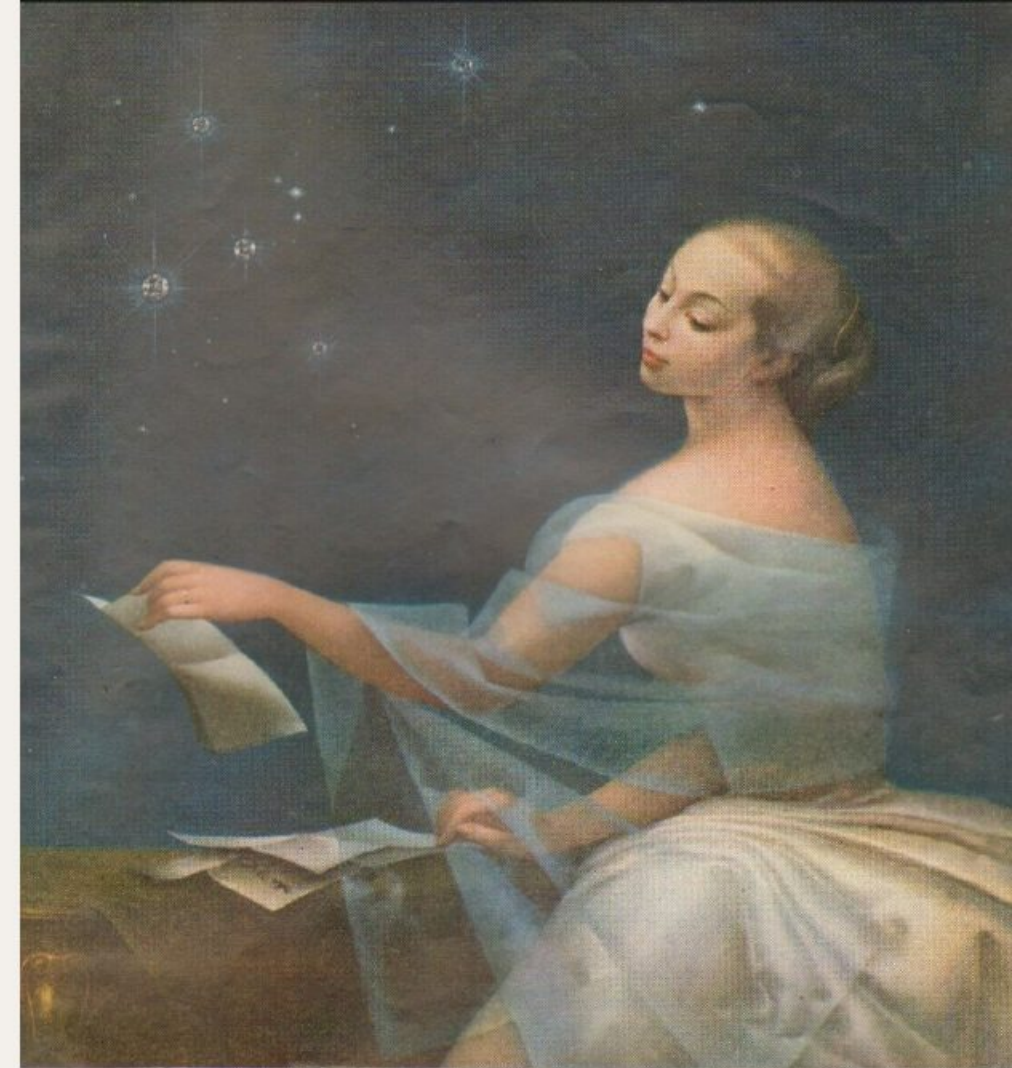
I

Genesis of a slogan

1938–1949

A letter from De Beers, a survey of American households, an antitrust constraint and a copywriter's late-night note: the conditions under which the most successful line in the history of advertising came into being.

"Love's dream written in starlight", N. W. Ayer & Son for De Beers.



The Constellation, Cygnus, the Swan. It is also called the Northern Cross. Painted for the De Beers Collection by Laura Wood

De Beers Constellation, Minsk

14 carat (28 points) \$10 to \$25
18 carat (36 points) \$30 to \$45
1 carat (100 points) \$245 to \$750
2 carat (200 points) \$1900 to \$3300

Price ranges above are based on quotations by jewellers throughout the country in April, 1956, for their top-grade engagement diamonds (brilliant-cut) in weights indicated. Prices vary with the qualities offered. Exceptionally fine stones are higher priced. Exact weights shown are infrequent. Add tax.



FACTS ABOUT DIAMONDS

Color, cutting and clarity, as well as carat weight, contribute to a diamond's beauty and value. A trained jeweller is your best adviser. Divided payments can usually be arranged.

LOVE'S DREAM WRITTEN IN STARLIGHT

Alight in the Milky Way, Cygnus, the Swan, is a bearer of dreams. For lovers, through centuries, have mused on his bright stars.

Deep in the earth, long ago, a star as beautiful and timeless was wrought for you and one you love.

Your engagement diamond holds inscribed in sparkling lights the dream of love that lends sweet meaning to the life you share.

It will keep a shining record of your destiny's fulfillment, for you and generations to be, until time's end.

A DIAMOND IS FOREVER

1. Stages of the Digest

The first stage of digestion is the ingestion of food. This is the process of taking food into the mouth and chewing it. The second stage is the digestion of food in the mouth. This is where the food is broken down into smaller pieces by the action of salivary enzymes. The third stage is the digestion of food in the stomach. This is where the food is broken down into even smaller pieces by the action of gastric enzymes.

The fourth stage is the digestion of food in the small intestine. This is where the food is broken down into its constituent nutrients. The fifth stage is the absorption of nutrients. This is where the nutrients are taken up by the body. The sixth stage is the elimination of waste. This is where the waste is removed from the body.

2. The Digestion

The process of digestion is a complex one. It involves the breakdown of food into its constituent nutrients. This is done by the action of enzymes. The first stage of digestion is the ingestion of food. This is where the food is taken into the mouth. The second stage is the digestion of food in the mouth. This is where the food is broken down into smaller pieces by the action of salivary enzymes. The third stage is the digestion of food in the stomach. This is where the food is broken down into even smaller pieces by the action of gastric enzymes.

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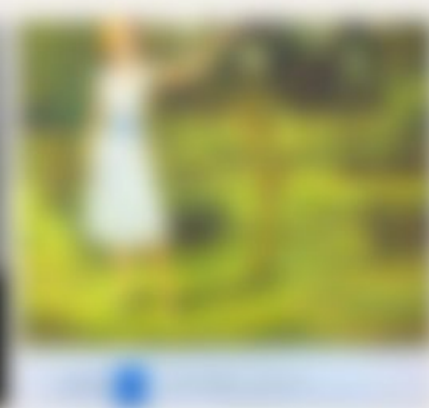
3. The Diet

The diet is the food and drink that we consume. It is the source of the nutrients that our body needs to function. A healthy diet is one that provides the body with the nutrients it needs in the right amounts. This includes carbohydrates, proteins, fats, vitamins, and minerals. A healthy diet also includes a variety of foods, including fruits, vegetables, grains, and meat.

The diet is an important part of our health. It can affect our energy levels, our mood, and our overall health. A healthy diet can help us to live longer and healthier lives. It can also help us to prevent many of the diseases that are common in our society. A healthy diet is one that provides the body with the nutrients it needs in the right amounts. This includes carbohydrates, proteins, fats, vitamins, and minerals.

1. *Portrait of a Man* by Leonardo da Vinci

2. *The Mona Lisa* by Leonardo da Vinci



3. *The Creation of Adam* by Michelangelo

4. *The Fall of Man* by Michelangelo

5. *The Creation of Adam* by Michelangelo

6. *The Creation of Adam* by Michelangelo

II

From tagline to myth

The cultural work of the slogan

Over the course of the twentieth century, the phrase “A Diamond is Forever” underwent a remarkable transformation, from a clever marketing tagline introduced in 1947 into one of the most enduring cultural symbols of love, commitment and social aspiration. Its legacy lies not only in the words themselves, but in how they reshaped global attitudes toward diamonds, love and ritual.

“Diamonds bespeak an ever-growing love”, N. W. Ayer & Son for De Beers, 1960s.



III

The slogan in the twenty-first century

Contemporary use and legacy

De Beers continues to use “A Diamond is Forever” as a central element of its brand identity. Between 2024 and 2025 the line was reasserted in two campaigns and sharpened against laboratory-grown stones, while the promise it carries was extended to the provenance of the stone itself.



1. The degree as a symbol

The degree is a symbol of achievement and a symbol of status. It is a symbol of the individual's achievement in a particular field of study or in a particular profession. It is a symbol of the individual's status in society. The degree is a symbol of the individual's achievement in a particular field of study or in a particular profession. It is a symbol of the individual's status in society.

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2. Degree as a marker of change

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THE DEGREE AS A SYMBOL OF ACHIEVEMENT AND STATUS

THE DEGREE AS A MARKER OF CHANGE

3. Cultural and ethnic adaptation

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IV

A new era

Four structural challenges

The erosion of aspiration among younger generations, the disruption of laboratory-grown diamonds, the gap between sustainability efforts and their perception, and the fragmentation of the narrative itself. Each is examined here in its context and in its consequences.



1. The generation of demand from individual demand curves

QUESTION What is the relationship between individual demand curves and the aggregate demand curve? What is the relationship between the aggregate demand curve and the individual demand curve? What is the relationship between the aggregate demand curve and the individual demand curve?

ANSWER

- The aggregate demand curve is the sum of all individual demand curves.
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QUESTION What is the relationship between the aggregate demand curve and the individual demand curve? What is the relationship between the aggregate demand curve and the individual demand curve?

2. Individual demand curves, market demand and average individual demand

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3. Demand elasticity and individual demand curves

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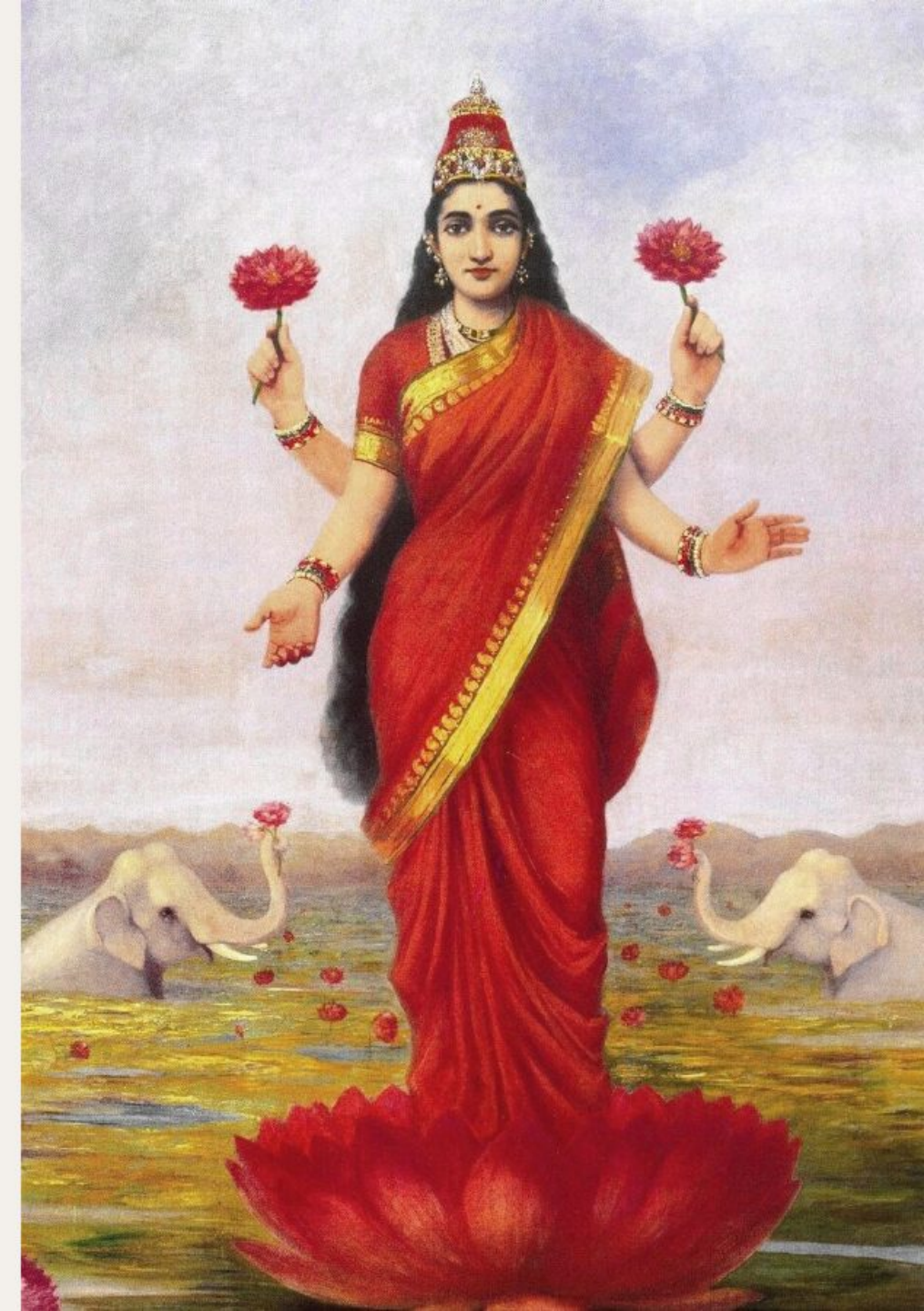
V

Three territories, different challenges

United States • India • China

The United States remains De Beers' largest and most historically profitable market, accounting for 45 to 50 per cent of global diamond jewellery sales, and also its most saturated, disrupted and symbolically unstable one. India represents one of the fastest-growing diamond markets globally, driven by a young, aspirational middle class and a long-standing love for precious materials, yet defined by deep symbolic tensions between tradition and modernity, price sensitivity and status, gold and diamond. China was, until 2019, the second-largest diamond jewellery market in the world; post-pandemic cultural shifts, a slowing economy and changes in consumer sentiment have since created a strategic standstill, marked by insecurity, pragmatism and a re-evaluation of luxury.

Lakshmi, goddess of wealth and fortune, chromolithograph after Raja Ravi Varma.



VI

The strategic response

Storytelling as cultural transmission

To rebuild trust, meaning and desire around the natural diamond, the strategy returns to the oldest communication system humans have created, and sets out a journey, a discourse, a community, its storytellers and its rituals.

Gathering around the fire.



THE HISTORY OF ART



VII

From slogan to philosophy

Conclusion

What truly endures is not the material, but the meaning we give it.

Natural diamond crystal.



